

DIFFERENTIAL GEOMETRY AND LIE GROUPS

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Fifth Semester

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Chapter 1

MANIFOLDS

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The primary reference for this course will be Loring Tu's *An Introduction to Manifolds*. Prerequisites include Analysis of Several Variables, Linear Algebra, and Topology. The mid-term will account for 35% of the final grade, quizzes and student lectures will account for 15%, and the final exam will account for 50%.

Simply put, a manifold is any object that is locally Euclidean.

1.1 Calculus on $\mathbb{R}^n$

A point p or element in $\mathbb{R}^n$ is associated with an n -tuple of coordinates $x^1, x^2, \dots, x^n$. Let U be an open neighbourhood of p in $\mathbb{R}^n$. For a non-negative integer k , we say that a function $f : U \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is C^k -continuous at $p \in U$ if all partial derivatives of f of order $\leq k$ exist and are continuous at p . f is said to be C^∞ or *smooth* if f is C^k for all $k \geq 0$. f is C^k (or C^∞) on U if it is C^k (or C^∞) at every point in U .

If f happens to be a vector-valued function, i.e. $f : U \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^m$, we say $f = (f^1, f^2, \dots, f^m)$ is C^k (or C^∞) at p if each component function $f^i : U \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is C^k (or C^∞) at p . f is C^k (or C^∞) on U if it is C^k (or C^∞) at every point in U .

Definition 1.1. Let R be a commutative ring with unity. We term A to be an R -algebra if A is a commutative ring with unity and an R -module, and for $r \in R$ and $a, b \in A$, we have $r(ab) = (ra)b = a(rb)$.

In this course, we will be primarily be concerned with the case when R is a field, and A is an R -vector space.

For a subset $U \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$, we denote $C^k(U)$ (or $C^\infty(U)$) as the set of all C^k (or C^∞) functions from U to $\mathbb{R}$. Note that this is a commutative ring with unity. It is also a vector space over $\mathbb{R}$. Together, $C^k(U)$ (or $C^\infty(U)$) is a (commutative) algebra over $\mathbb{R}$. Moreover, we have the descending chain of subalgebras

$$C^0(U) \supseteq C^1(U) \supseteq C^2(U) \supseteq \dots C^k(U) \supseteq C^{k+1}(U) \supseteq \dots \quad (1.1)$$

with

$$\bigcap_{k \geq 0} C^k(U) = C^\infty(U). \quad (1.2)$$

$f : U \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is termed *real analytic* at $p \in U$ if there exists a neighbourhood $V \subseteq U$ of p such that

$$f(x) = f(p) + \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{\partial f}{\partial x^i}(p)(x^i - p^i) + \dots + \frac{1}{k!} \sum_{1 \leq i_1, \dots, i_k \leq n} \frac{\partial^k f}{\partial x^{i_1} \dots \partial x^{i_k}}(p)(x^{i_1} - p^{i_1}) \dots (x^{i_k} - p^{i_k}) + \dots \quad (1.3)$$

for all $x \in V$. f is said to be real analytic on U if it is real analytic at every point in U . We denote the set of all real analytic functions on U as $C^\omega(U)$. Note that $C^\omega(U) \subseteq C^\infty(U)$.

Theorem 1.2 (*Taylor's theorem*). Let $p \in U \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$, and $f : U \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be a C^∞ function. Further assume that for all $x \in U$, the line segment from p to x is contained in U (U in this case is said to be star-shaped with respect to p). Then there exist $g_1, \dots, g_n \in C^\infty(U)$ such that, for all $x \in U$,

$$f(x) = f(p) + \sum_{i=1}^n g_i(x)(x^i - p^i), \quad (1.4)$$

with

$$g_i(p) = \frac{\partial f}{\partial x^i}(p), \quad 1 \leq i \leq n. \quad (1.5)$$

Proof. Let $x \in U$. Then the line segment $\{p + t(x - p) \mid t \in [0, 1]\}$ is contained in U . Composing f with the map $t \mapsto p + t(x - p)$, we obtain

$$\frac{df}{dt}(p + t(x - p)) = \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{\partial f}{\partial x^i}(p + t(x - p))(x^i - p^i). \quad (1.6)$$

Integrating from 0 to 1, we get

$$f(x) - f(p) = \int_0^1 \frac{df}{dt}(p + t(x - p))dt = \sum_{i=1}^n (x^i - p^i) \int_0^1 \frac{\partial f}{\partial x^i}(p + t(x - p))dt = \sum_{i=1}^n (x^i - p^i)g_i(x). \quad (1.7)$$

Clearly, because f is C^∞ , each g_i is also C^∞ . Further, we have $g_i(p) = \int_0^1 \frac{\partial f}{\partial x^i}(p)dt = \frac{\partial f}{\partial x^i}(p)$. ■

Let $p = (p^1, \dots, p^n)$, $v \in \mathbb{R}^n$, and $f : U \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ be C^∞ at p . The *directional derivative* of f at p in the direction of v is defined as

$$\lim_{t \rightarrow 0} \frac{f(p + tv) - f(p)}{t} = \left. \frac{d}{dt} f(p + tv) \right|_{t=0} = \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{df}{dx^i}(p)v^i. \quad (1.8)$$

From here, we obtain the operator

$$D_v = \sum_{i=1}^n v^i \frac{\partial}{\partial x^i} \Big|_p \quad (1.9)$$

Now consider all pairs of the form (f, U) where $p \in U \subseteq \mathbb{R}^n$ is an open neighbourhood of p and $f : U \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ is C^∞ . Define an equivalence relation $\sim$ on this set by declaring $(f, U) \sim (g, V)$ if and only if there exists an open neighbourhood $W \subseteq U \cap V$ of p such that $f|_W = g|_W$. The equivalence class of (f, U) is denoted by $[(f, U)]$, and the set of all such equivalence classes is denoted by $C_p^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n)$. Such an equivalence class $[(f, U)]$ is called the *germ* of f at p . We can give $C_p^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n)$ the structure of a commutative ring with unity by defining

$$[(f, U)] + [(g, V)] = [(f + g, U \cap V)], \quad [(f, U)] \cdot [(g, V)] = [(fg, U \cap V)], \quad 1 = [(1, \mathbb{R}^n)]. \quad (1.10)$$

It can also be given the structure of a vector space over $\mathbb{R}$ by defining

$$\lambda[(f, U)] = [(\lambda f, U)], \quad \lambda \in \mathbb{R}. \quad (1.11)$$

Thus, $C_p^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n)$ is an $\mathbb{R}$ -algebra. Now, given a germ $\alpha = [(f, U)] \in C_p^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n)$ and a vector $v \in \mathbb{R}^n$, we define

$$D_v \alpha = \sum_{i=1}^n v^i \frac{\partial f}{\partial x^i} \Big|_p = v \cdot \nabla f(p). \quad (1.12)$$

Note that the choice of f is immaterial, since if $[(f, U)] = [(g, V)]$, then there exists an open neighbourhood $W \subseteq U \cap V$ of p such that $f|_W = g|_W$, and hence $\nabla f(p) = \nabla g(p)$. One can infer that $D_{\lambda v}(f) = \lambda D_v(f) = D_v(\lambda f)$ and $D_v(f + g) = D_v(f) + D_v(g)$ for all $\lambda \in \mathbb{R}$ and $f, g \in C_p^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n)$. Thus, D_v is an $\mathbb{R}$ -linear map from $C_p^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n)$ to $\mathbb{R}$ (hereforth, we shall use f to also denote the germ $[(f, U)]$ of f at p). Also,

$$D_v(fg) = \sum_{i=1}^n v^i \frac{\partial(fg)}{\partial x^i}(p) = \sum_{i=1}^n v^i \left(f(p) \frac{\partial g}{\partial x^i}(p) + g(p) \frac{\partial f}{\partial x^i}(p) \right) = f(p)D_v(g) + g(p)D_v(f). \quad (1.13)$$

Such a property makes D_v what we call a derivation.

Definition 1.3. Any $\mathbb{R}$ -linear map $T : C_p^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ satisfying the Leibniz rule $T(fg) = f(p)T(g) + g(p)T(f)$ for all $f, g \in C_p^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n)$ is called a *derivation* at p .

One may show that if T is a derivation at p , then $T(1) = 0$.

The set of all derivations at p is denoted by $\mathfrak{D}_p(\mathbb{R}^n)$. It is easy to see that $\mathfrak{D}_p(\mathbb{R}^n)$ is a vector space over $\mathbb{R}$. Now consider the map

$$\theta : \mathbb{R}^n \rightarrow \mathfrak{D}_p(\mathbb{R}^n), \quad v \mapsto D_v. \quad (1.14)$$

This θ is an $\mathbb{R}$ -linear map (verify). We claim that θ is an isomorphism of real vector spaces. To this end, let $v \in \mathbb{R}^n$ such that $D_v = 0 \in \mathfrak{D}_p(\mathbb{R}^n)$. Then $D_v f = 0$ for all $f \in C_p^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n)$. In particular, for the coordinate functions x^i , we have $D_v x^i = v_i = 0$ for all $1 \leq i \leq n$. Thus, $v = 0$, and hence θ is injective. To show surjectivity, we appeal to Taylor's theorem; let $D \in \mathfrak{D}_p(\mathbb{R}^n)$. We claim that $D = D_v$ where $v = (D(x^1), \dots, D(x^n))$. Indeed, for any $f \in C_p^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n)$, we have

$$\begin{aligned} D(f) &= D(f(p)) + D\left(\sum_{i=1}^n (x^i - p^i)g_i(x)\right) = 0 + \sum_{i=1}^n ((x^i - p^i)(p)Dg_i(x) + D(x^i - p^i)g_i(p)) \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^n (Dx^i)g_i(p) = \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{\partial f}{\partial x^i}(p)Dx^i = D_v(f). \end{aligned} \quad (1.15)$$

Hence, θ is surjective, and we have the desired isomorphism $\mathfrak{D}_p(\mathbb{R}^n) \cong \mathbb{R}^n$.

Note that a germ $f \in C_p^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n)$ has a valid value at p , but no other point. Hence, we have the evaluation map

$$\text{ev}_p : C_p^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}, \quad [(f, U)] \mapsto f(p). \quad (1.16)$$

The kernel here is $\{[(f, U)] \in C_p^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n) \mid f(p) = 0\}$, which is an ideal in $C_p^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n)$. For any other element $[(f, U)] \in C_p^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n)$ with $f(p) \neq 0$, a valid inverse is given by $[(f^{-1}, U \setminus \{f = 0\})]$. This makes $C_p^\infty(\mathbb{R}^n)$ a local ring.

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